

Thetis Light

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Nereus and Doris had fifty daughters (Theogony, line 264). Thetis is one of the Daughters of Nereus. As a group, they are called the Nereids. Thetis was given to Peleus (a mortal) for his undying devotion to the gods on Mount Olympos (Olympus). Thetis and Peleus had a magnificent son, Akhilleus. The fate of Akhilleus was known to Thetis. Simply put, Akhilleus could return to his father and die happy yet forgotten, or, he could die at Troy and be remembered forever as a hero.

To protect her son in battle, Thetis provided Akhilleus with armor made by Hephaistos (Hephaestus), the smith of the gods. But during the war at Troy, Akhilleus was angered by Agamemnon, he refused to fight. Instead, he gave his armor to his friend Patroklos (Patroklos). Patroklos was killed as he pressed the attack to the walls of Ilion (Troy). The most brutal fighting of the war was for the armor of Akhilleus and the body of Patroklos. The disgrace to his friend's body and the theft of his armor brought Akhilleus into the battle, but not before Thetis could persuade Hephaistos to forge new armor for her, soon to be immortalized, son.

When Akhilleus strode into battle with his new armor, the Trojans fled in terror. His divine protection was obvious from the blaze of his armor and his divine lineage was also obvious from his beauty and his enormous strength. The Trojans who did not have the good sense or swift feet to run away, were killed. After Akhilleus had had his revenge, Thetis led a procession of her sisters up from the depths to mourn openly and to cast a divine mist over the body of Patroklos.